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all enjoy playing games and basking in the glory of their stunning visuals and addictive stories. With PC hardware becoming stronger than ever and technologies like real-time-ray tracing (RTX) making their way into the mainstream, the world of gaming and especially the design side of things are more interesting than ever. Now, if you are someone like us, at some point you would have wondered if you could try your hand at game design. Heck, even take it up as a career. I mean, why not?

If that is the case, then you are in the perfect place, as this month we are covering the world of game designing and bringing you a handy guide that'll help you get started on the road to becoming a game designer. And, if you are looking for other gaming-related careers, let me give you some spoilers. Over the next few months, we will be covering a variety of gaming-related careers. So, keep on reading SKOAR! Who knows what strikes a chord with you?

Game Design: What even is it?

The world of game design is very complex. To put it simply, as a game designer, you are responsible for the most essential elements of a game, including, but not limited to, story writing, gameplay direction, level design and management. You are the boss, what you say goes, because you are the one taking the game from an idea to an actual product.

As lucrative a career in game design may sound, the responsibilities that come with it make it a job

that can earn you a lot of fame but also put you in the firing line for all the criticism if the game does not perform as expected in any way, shape or form. While there are various disciplines that you can specialise in, when you are on your way to become a game designer, there are some blanket responsibilities that apply. To give you an idea of what they are, here's a very interesting list compiled by the folks at Western Governors University –

- Brainstorm new game ideas that would engage a wider audience,
- Outline the game's concept and storyboard the overall game experience,
- Develop characters and plots based on the storyboard of the game,
- Develop the code necessary for a game to work,
- Document the code and work out any bugs or issues with the code,
- Work with developers and other members of their team to ensure

that there are no bugs or problems from start to finish,

- Respond to feedback about concerns with the game, and
- Create patches or bug fixes to ensure that the game continues to work well.

You see what I mean, right?

To make sure that you are on your A-game all the time, there are some essential things like creativity and time management that you need to level up on, if you're to cut it as a game designer. That is true with any creative career, but when you are working as a game designer, whose vision can make or break a game, it becomes even more important. Given the fact that a game has a variety of people with varying interests, backgrounds, and skill level involved as the stakeholders, you need to make sure that everything comes together and the game makes sense to the end user overall. So now that you know what it means to be a

